

Nicholas Bamshad Aoki

Curriculum Vitae as of August 26, 2026

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RESEARCH INTERESTS

cognitive science, psycholinguistics, sociolinguistics, phonetics/phonology, speech perception, human-AI interaction

EMPLOYMENT

2026- **University of California, Davis**
Postdoctoral Affiliate, Phonetics Laboratory, Department of Linguistics

EDUCATION

Degrees

2021-2026 **University of California, Davis**
Ph.D. in Linguistics
Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00
Dissertation: From Idiosyncrasy to Generalization: The Role of Sociolinguistic Experience on Adaptation to Novel Talkers
Committee: Georgia Zellou, Fernanda Ferreira, Santiago Barreda-Castañón

2020-2021 **University of Chicago**
M.A. in Digital Studies of Language, Culture, and History
Cumulative GPA: 4.00/4.00
Thesis: Do Hillary Clinton and Kamala Harris Imitate the Accent of their Audience at Campaign Rallies?
Advisor: Alan C. L. Yu

2017-2021 **University of Chicago**
B.A. in Linguistics, Minor in Statistics
Cumulative GPA: 3.95/4.00
College Honors: Phi Beta Kappa, Student Marshal, *summa cum laude*

Non-Degrees

- 2025 **University of Oregon**
Linguistic Society of America Summer Institute
- 2018 **University of Chicago Center in Paris**, Paris, France
Advanced French Study Abroad Program

PUBLICATIONS AND MANUSCRIPTS*Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles*

- 2026 Georgia Zellou, Nicole Holliday, and **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Introduction to the special issue on the phonetics of human-AI interaction. Forthcoming at *Phonetica*.
- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers. *Language and Speech*, 69(3), 946-976.
<https://doi.org/10.1177/00238309251390505>
- 2025 Maryam Bamshad, Karina Xie, Rema Rasheed, Kathryn Holt, Grace Assabil-Bentum, & **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Exposure to subtle dominance cues in asymmetric power relationships activates the stress response and affects decision-making. *Frontiers in Psychology*, 16, 1517308.
<https://doi.org/10.3389/fpsyg.2025.1517308>
- 2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Insights into the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *Glossa Psycholinguistics*, 4(1). <https://doi.org/10.5070/g6011.21217>
- 2024 Jules Vonessen, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn & Georgia Zellou. Comparing perception of L1 and L2 English by human listeners and machines: Effect of interlocutor adaptations. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 155(5), 3060-3070. <https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0025930>
- 2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Being *clear* about clear speech: Intelligibility of hard-of-hearing-directed, non-native-directed, and casual speech for L1- and L2-English listeners. *Journal of Phonetics*, 104, 101328.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wocn.2024.101328>
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Visual information affects adaptation to novel talkers: Ethnicity-specific and ethnicity-independent learning of L2-accented speech. *The Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*, 154(4), 2290-2304. <https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0021289>
- 2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn, & Georgia Zellou. The clear speech intelligibility benefit for text-to-speech voices: Effects of speaking style and visual guise. *JASA Express Letters*, 2(4), 045204.
<https://doi.org/10.1121/10.0010274>

Refereed Conference Proceedings

- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. When clear speech does not enhance memory: Effects of speaking style, voice naturalness, and listener age. *Proceedings of Meetings on Acoustics*, 51(1), 060002. <https://doi.org/10.1121/2.0001766>
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** & Georgia Zellou. Speakers talk more clearly when they see an East Asian face: Effects of visual guise on speech production. In Radek Skarnitzl & Jan Volín (Eds.), *Proceedings of the 20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences* (pp. 2294-2298). Guarant International. <https://tinyurl.com/y6kdncv9>

INVITED PRESENTATIONS AND GUEST LECTURES

- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Language-based markers of cognitive decline: Integrating a sociolinguistic perspective. *Invited talk at the laboratory of Dr. Christina Young*. University of California, Davis.
- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki**. Phonology in use: Usage-based phonology and the usefulness of phonological theory for career development. *Guest lecture at Introduction to Phonological Theory [LIN 111]*. University of California, Davis.
- 2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki**. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Insights into the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *Invited talk at The Berkeley Phonetics, Phonology and Psycholinguistics Forum*. University of California, Berkeley.
- 2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki**. From qualifying paper to journal article: Tips and tricks for successful publication. *Guest lecture at Proseminar [LIN 201]*. University of California, Davis.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

[* = Undergraduate trainee supervised by NBA]

- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *The 20th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*. Montréal, Canada.
- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *12th UC Davis Symposium on Language Research*. Davis, USA.
- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you glitching on me?: Investigating phonological adaptation and generalization across human and device guises. *190th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Philadelphia, USA.
- 2026 *Bayleigh Baldwin, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Lacey Wade, and Georgia Zellou. Talkin' country in w[a:]ne country: Sociolinguistic variation in Napa, California. *50th Annual Penn Linguistics Conference*. Philadelphia, USA.

- 2026 Karina Xie, Fairuz Abdalla, Brittany Augustin, Brenda Flores, Luisiana Guzman, Yawa Koumako, Salwa Mohammed, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Maryam Bamshad. Medical decision-making is impacted by the doctor's speech tone and framing of probability statement for the treatment success. *The New England Science Symposium*. Boston, USA.
- 2026 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers: Evidence for numerosity and similarity accounts of cross-talker generalization. *100th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. New Orleans, USA.
- 2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Apparent talker variability and speaking style similarity can enhance comprehension of novel L2-accented talkers: Evidence for numerosity and similarity accounts of cross-talker generalization. *189th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Honolulu, USA.
- 2025 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Social co-variation facilitates the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *99th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. Philadelphia, USA.
- 2024 *Bayleigh Baldwin, **Nicholas B. Aoki**, and Georgia Zellou. "Country Talk" in California's Napa Valley. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52*. Miami, USA.
- 2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When multiple talker exposure is necessary for cross-talker generalization: Social co-variation facilitates the emergence of sociolinguistic perception. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 52*. Miami, USA.
- 2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Effects of speaking style and apparent talker variability on perceptual adaptation to L2-accented speech. *10th UC Davis Symposium on Language Research*. Davis, USA.
- 2024 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Ethnicity-specific and -independent learning: Effects of guise on adaptation to novel foreign-accented talkers. *98th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. New York City, USA.
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. When speaking clearly does not enhance comprehension: Comparing intelligibility of hard-of-hearing- and non-native-directed speech for native and non-native listeners. *185th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Sydney, Australia.
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Ethnicity-specific and -independent learning: Effects of guise on adaptation to novel foreign-accented talkers. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 51*. New York City, USA.
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Speakers talk more clearly when they see an Asian face: Effects of visual guise on speech production. *20th International Congress of Phonetic Sciences*. Prague, Czech Republic.

- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Comparing intelligibility and recognition memory of human and text-to-speech voices. *184th Meeting of the Acoustical Society of America*. Chicago, USA.
- 2023 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Masoud Jasbi, and Georgia Zellou. Under-informative utterances can be more accepted from digital devices than humans. *97th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*. Denver, USA.
- 2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Georgia Zellou. Hey Alexa, are you a Valley Girl? Effects of social information on the perception of text-to-speech voices. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 50*. San Jose, USA.
- 2022 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Michelle Cohn, and Georgia Zellou. The clear speech intelligibility benefit for TTS Voices: Effects of speech style and guise. *The 18th Conference on Laboratory Phonology*, Virtual.
- 2021 **Nicholas B. Aoki** and Alan C. L. Yu. Do Hillary Clinton and Kamala Harris imitate the accent of their audiences? Analysis and interpretation of stylistic variability. *New Ways of Analyzing Variation 49*, Virtual.
- 2021 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Henry Mackall, and Alan C. L. Yu. Does variation in speech production impact acoustic cue weighting in speech perception? *2021 University of Chicago Undergraduate Research Symposium*, Virtual.
- 2020 **Nicholas B. Aoki**, Jacob B. Phillips, Daniel Chen, and Alan C. L. Yu. Convergence of the lot-thought merger in the U.S. Supreme Court. *94th Annual Meeting of the Linguistic Society of America*, New Orleans, USA.

MEDIA APPEARANCES

- 2023 Kat Setzer. Student Paper Competition: Chicago [19:49-30:53]. Across Acoustics [Official Podcast of the Acoustical Society of America].
<https://acrossacoustics.buzzsprout.com/1537384/14065240-student-paper-competition-chicago>

AWARDS AND HONORS

- 2026 Bob Bayley Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, \$1200
- 2026 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award, UC Davis, \$1000
- 2026 Sigma Xi, UC Davis
- 2025 Graduate Student Travel Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, \$500
- 2025 Student Transportation Award, Acoustical Society of America, \$150
- 2025 Linguistic Society of America (LSA) Summer Institute Fellowship, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, \$5668
- 2025 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award Nominee, UC Davis
- 2024 Outstanding Graduate Student Teaching Award Nominee, UC Davis

2024	Phi Kappa Phi, UC Davis
2023	Proceedings of Meetings on Acoustics Student Paper Competition Winner, Acoustical Society of America, \$300
2023	“Down Under Funder” Travel Grant, Acoustical Society of America, \$1,000
2023	Steven Lapointe Award, UC Davis Department of Linguistics, \$850
2023	Student Award, International Phonetic Association, GBP 600
2022	Travel Award, UC Davis Graduate Student Association, \$250
2022-2023	Graduate Research Mentorship Fellowship, UC Davis, \$48,900
2021-2022	Provost’s Fellowship in the Arts, Humanities, and Social Sciences, UC Davis, \$59,802
2021	Latin Honors (summa cum laude), Univ. of Chicago
2021	Leonard Bloomfield Prize in Linguistics, Univ. of Chicago
2020	Phi Beta Kappa (Early Induction), Univ. of Chicago
2020	Student Marshal, Univ. of Chicago
2020	College Summer Research Fellow, Univ. of Chicago, \$5,000
2019-2020	College Research in the Arts, Social Sciences, and Humanities Scholar, Univ. of Chicago \$5,000
2019	Jeff Metcalf Internship, Univ. of Chicago
2019	Dean’s Fund for Undergraduate Research Award, Univ. of Chicago, \$1,271
2019	Liew Family College Research Fellow, Univ. of Chicago, \$1,000
2017-2021	Dean’s List, Univ. of Chicago
2017-2021	National Merit Scholarship, \$8,000

TEACHING

LIN 171 – Introduction to Psycholinguistics (Winter '24, Spring '25)

LIN 111 – Introduction to Phonological Theory (Spring '26)

LIN 103A – Linguistic Analysis I: Phonetics, Phonology, Morphology (Fall '24, Winter '26)

LIN 001/001Y – Introduction to Linguistics (Fall '23, Spring '24, Summer Session I '24, Summer Session II '24, Winter '25, Spring '25, Fall '25)

GRADUATE ADVISING

2026-	Sela Martin-Lopez, UC Davis [co-mentor with Georgia Zellou]
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UNDERGRADUATE ADVISING***Honors Theses***

2024-2025 Bayleigh Baldwin, “The social meaning of ‘Country Talk’ in California’s Napa Valley”, UC Davis [co-mentor with Georgia Zellou]

Research Assistants

2025 Hyunjin (Dylan) Lim, UC Davis

2023 Lilly Vanhoy, UC Davis

SERVICE***Editor***

2025-2026 *Phonetica*, Special Issue on Phonetics of Human-AI interaction, Co-guest editor (along with Georgia Zellou and Nicole Holliday)

Ad-hoc Journal Reviewing

2026 *Linguistics Vanguard*, Ampersand

2025 *Speech Communication* [n = 2], *Journal of Phonetics*

2024 *Journal of the Acoustical Society of America*

2022 *Journal of the Acoustical Society of America* [co-review w/ Georgia Zellou]

Conference Abstract Reviewing

2025-2026 California Meeting on Psycholinguistics

2022-2026 UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Symposium

Organized Sessions and Symposia

2023 UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Symposium (co-organized with Roxanne Elliott and Ana Ortega Pérez)

Other Service

2026 Panelist, UC Davis Undergraduate Linguistics Club [Q+A Session About Graduate School Applications]

2025 Member, California Meeting on Psycholinguistics Planning Committee

2024-2026 Website Manager, UC Davis Phonetics Lab

2023-2024	Website Manager, UC Davis Linguistics Department [Creator of Position]
2023-2024	Representative, UC Davis Graduate Student Association
2022-2023	Volunteer Tutor, Sacramento Public Library Adult Literacy Program
2022-2026	Member, UC Davis Cluster on Language Research Committee
2021-2022	Member, UC Davis Graduate and Professional School Events Review Board
2020-2021	Member, Univ. of Chicago Senior Class Gift Committee
2017-2021	Founder, Univ. of Chicago Phoenix Tutoring (President, Coordinator, Tutor)

LANGUAGES

English (L1 or “native”), French (advanced), Spanish (advanced), Japanese (intermediate), Farsi (beginning)

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Coding: R, R Markdown, LaTeX, Python, HTML, CSS, JavaScript

Acoustic-Phonetic Analysis: Praat, FastTrack, Forced Alignment (FAVE, WebMAUS, Montreal Forced Aligner), ELAN

Experiment Development: Qualtrics, Gorilla, Prolific, E-Prime

Miscellaneous: eye-tracking, EEG, iMotions

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS

2026-	Sigma Xi
2024-	Phi Kappa Phi
2023-	Acoustical Society of America
2023-	International Phonetic Association
2022-	Association for Laboratory Phonology
2020-	Linguistic Society of America
2020-	Phi Beta Kappa

REFERENCES**Dr. Georgia Zellou**

Professor of Linguistics
University of California, Davis
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Dr. Nicole Holliday

Associate Professor of Linguistics
University of California, Berkeley
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Dr. Fernanda Ferreira

Professor of Psychology
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Dr. Laurel Lawyer

Associate Professor of Linguistics
University of California, Davis
lalawyer@ucdavis.edu

Dr. Emily Morgan

Associate Professor of Linguistics
University of California, Davis
eimorgan@ucdavis.edu

Dr. Alan C. L. Yu

Professor of Linguistics
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